THE ANT EFFECT

From the Himalayas to Urban Streets

A Student Workshop on Environmental Awareness, Climate Resilience and Everyday Action

Proposed date: 24 October 2026

1. Overview

ITEM	DETAIL
Organizer	Earth's Ants, in collaboration with the school Organizing Club
Audience	Students of Classes 4–10, with age-appropriate activities
Duration	25 minutes (strict schedule)
Format	Short explainer video, three interactive activities, pledge, and prize ceremony
Focus areas	Glacier-related flash flooding in Nepal (August 2026), climate change, single-use plastic alternatives, and everyday environmental habits in Bangladesh
Core promise	Every student leaves with one practical action they can start the same day.

Core message: A river connects the Himalayas to our homes. Warming and changes in mountain ice can contribute to sudden floods, while plastic waste blocking drains can worsen waterlogging in our towns and cities. These are different problems, but both show how our environment is connected. Like ants working together, small and consistent actions can create a bigger impact.

2. Objectives and Learning Outcomes

By the end of the workshop, students will be able to:

- Explain in simple terms how a glacier-related collapse contributed to the Nepal flash flood and why scientists are studying the possible role of warming.
- Describe how plastic and other waste can block drains and make local waterlogging worse.
- Use the solution ladder—Refuse, Reduce or Substitute, Carry It Back, and Dispose Responsibly—in everyday situations, including when no bin is available.
- Encourage a family member, shopkeeper, or neighbour to change a harmful habit in a respectful way.
- Choose one daily action through the Ant Pledge and take part in the 7-Day Ant Streak.

3. Audience and Age-Tiering

TIER	CLASSES	ADJUSTMENTS
Junior	4–6	Use picture cards and simple language. Keep acting short and avoid scissors. Suggested pledge: "I will carry my own bag or bottle."
Middle	7–8	Use standard situation cards, solution-ladder scoring, and a one-week home mission such as refusing an unnecessary polythene bag.
Senior	9–10	Run a focused small-group discussion (FGD) followed by short group presentations. Students identify a local environmental problem, discuss practical solutions, and present one realistic action plan. Classes 8 may be assigned to the senior activity based on school needs; otherwise, they can follow the middle-tier format.

4. Run of Show (25 Minutes)

TIME	SEGMENT	LEAD
0:00–3:00	Welcome, quick habit check, and 90-second explainer video	Lead facilitator
3:00–8:00	Activity 1: Human River Rescue	Activity 1 referee
8:00–14:00	Activity 2: No Bin? No Problem!	Activity 2 judges
14:00–20:00	Activity 3: Fix the Habit — Senior FGD and Group Presentation for Classes 8–10	Activity 3 facilitator/judges
20:00–22:00	Ant Pledge, Ant Wall, and Ant Streak cards	Lead facilitator
22:00–25:00	Results and prize ceremony	Lead facilitator

5. Segment Details

5.1 Welcome and Explainer Video (0:00–3:00)

Opening habit check (about 30 seconds)

“Let’s start with a quick game about everyday habits. If you have ever done one of these things, please stand up. Be honest—this is not an exam, and nobody is here to judge you. We are here to learn together. Ready?”

- Have you ever dropped a chips packet or chocolate wrapper on the street?
- Have you ever left a bottle beside a road or thrown waste into a drain?
- Have you ever left a light or fan switched on after leaving a room?
- Have you ever thrown rubbish out of a bus, car, or rickshaw?

Closing line: “Look around. We have all made mistakes, and we can all make better choices. Like ants, small actions become powerful when many of us do them consistently. That is the Ant Effect!”

Explainer video (90 seconds): Use a simple animated slide explainer made in Canva or PowerPoint, with clear narration. Avoid raw news footage showing destruction, injured people, or loss of life.

Suggested four-step narration:

1. High in the mountains: On 26 August 2026, a large section of a glacier near the Nepal–Tibet border broke away.
2. The avalanche: Falling ice carried rock and soil into a small river called the Lhende Khola.
3. The surge: Debris temporarily blocked the river. When the blockage gave way, a flash flood travelled downstream through the Bhote Koshi and Trishuli valleys.
4. Why scientists are concerned: Warmer conditions can allow meltwater to enter glaciers and weaken the connection between ice and rock. Scientists are still investigating exactly how much warming contributed to this event.

Accuracy and sensitivity rules

- Early reports suggested an earthquake, but the US Geological Survey ruled this out. Do not repeat the earthquake explanation.
- Do not include casualty numbers, graphic images, or footage showing loss of life.
- Recheck the facts the day before the session because reports may change.
- Use properly credited satellite images or public updates from reliable sources, including The Conversation’s analysis and ICIMOD. Check each image’s licence and credit requirements.

5.2 Activity 1: Human River Rescue (3:00–8:00)

Purpose: Help students understand how water moves through a connected system and distinguish a sudden mountain flood from local drain blockage.

Setup: Each team of 6–8 students forms a line between a “mountain/glacier” mat and a “village” mat, about 5–8 metres apart. Use a blue cloth or paper strips to represent water and soft, crumpled paper balls to represent debris or plastic waste.

Round 1 — Mountain surge (about 2 minutes): The referee announces “Mountain surge!” Teams pass blue strips hand-to-hand from the mountain to the village without dropping them. The facilitator can add extra strips to represent a sudden increase in water arriving.

Round 2 — Clogged drain (about 2 minutes): The facilitator places paper balls in a marked “drain” zone. Students keep the blue strips moving while removing the paper balls and placing them in a bucket.

Debrief (about 1 minute): Ask: “Were the two rounds showing the same problem? What can communities do about blocked drains? What can we do to reduce waste?” Make clear that the Nepal event was a glacier-related avalanche and flash flood, not a flood caused by plastic.

Scoring: Award 1 point for each water strip delivered safely and 1 point for each paper obstacle removed. If using the original penalty system, apply it consistently across all teams. Safety comes first: no running, pushing, or aggressive throwing.

5.3 Activity 2: No Bin? No Problem! (8:00–14:00)

Purpose: Practise realistic ways to reduce and manage waste when a bin is not immediately available.

Setup: Create four stations: Tea Stall, Bazaar, Street-Food Cart, and Canal Bank. Each station has a volunteer judge and 2–3 situation cards. Divide students into teams and rotate them at the facilitator’s signal. If the group is large, teams can respond to one station each to keep the session on time.

The solution ladder (higher-priority choices should earn more points):

5. Refuse: Say no to an unnecessary item, such as an extra plastic bag or straw.
6. Reduce or substitute: Bring a reusable bag, cup, or container, or choose an option with less packaging.
7. Carry it back: Keep the waste safely in your own bag or pouch until you find a suitable bin.
8. Dispose responsibly: Use the correct bin or waste collection point when available. Never leave waste in a canal, drain, or on the street.

How to play: Teams draw a card, discuss for about 20–30 seconds, then act out or explain their solution in one sentence. Keep each response brief so several teams can participate.

Scoring (up to 10 points per round): practicality (4), use of the solution ladder (3), and clarity/politeness (3). If the shortened station format is needed, judges may use a simple 3-point scale: practical solution, waste reduction/reuse, and clear explanation.

Example situation cards: “You finished a snack and there is no bin nearby”; “The wastebasket is full”; “A shopkeeper offers you a plastic bag, but you brought a reusable bag”; “You bought street food and the vendor gave you disposable packaging”; “A bag is labelled biodegradable, but you are not sure how it should be disposed of.”

5.4 Activity 3: Fix the Habit — FGD and Group Presentation (14:00–20:00)

Primary format for Classes 8–10: Replace the senior-tier role-play with a short, structured focus group discussion (FGD) and group presentation. The goal is to move beyond identifying problems and help students propose realistic solutions.

Purpose: Identify everyday environmental problems, discuss practical solutions, and practise communicating an action plan respectfully.

Setup: Before the session, divide students into small groups of 5–7. Display or distribute one prompt per group. Provide paper or a small slate for notes. Groups should be ready to start immediately.

Suggested six-minute format

TIME	STEP	INSTRUCTIONS
0:00–0:30	Introduce the challenge	Explain that each group must identify one problem and suggest solutions that students can realistically carry out.
0:30–3:00	Focus group discussion	Students discuss the prompt, share ideas, and agree on one priority solution and one supporting action. A group member records the main points.
3:00–5:30	Group presentations	Each group gives a 30–45 second presentation. If there are many groups, invite a selection to present and collect the remaining plans on paper.
5:30–6:00	Quick feedback	The facilitator highlights practical, respectful, and achievable ideas. Ask students to name one action they could start today.

Discussion prompts

- Plastic waste and blocked drains: What can students, shops, and the school do to reduce the problem?
- No bin nearby: What should someone do with snack packaging when there is no bin available?
- Reusable alternatives: How can students encourage the use of reusable bags, bottles, or lunch boxes without blaming people?
- Family action: Which single habit could your household change this week, and how would you encourage the change?
- “Biodegradable” packaging: What should a responsible consumer check before assuming that a product will safely break down?

Required group presentation structure

9. Problem: State the environmental problem in one clear sentence.
10. Reason: Explain why it matters, using one example from school, home, or the local community.
11. Solution: Suggest one practical and affordable change.
12. Action: Say who can do it and what the group can start within seven days.

Scoring (10 points): understanding the problem (2), practicality and affordability (3), teamwork and inclusion (2), clarity of presentation (2), and respectful communication (1).

5.5 Wrap-up: My Ant Move (20:00–22:00)

TIME	STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
0:00–0:25	1. Pick your Ant Move	Show icons or simple words: carry waste until a bin is found, use a bin, switch off lights and fans, close the tap, or carry a reusable bag/bottle. Ask students to choose the easiest action for them.
0:25–1:05	2. Make an If–Then promise	Give each student a paper ant with the sentence: “When I _____, I will _____.” Examples: “When I finish a snack, I will keep the wrapper in my bag until I find a bin.” “When I leave a room, I will switch off the light and fan.”

1:05–2:00	3. Ant Wall and 7-Day Ant Streak	Students add their promise to the Ant Wall or keep an Ant Streak card to track the action for seven days.

6.Scoring and Prize System

THEME	PRIZE	WHY IT FITS	COST LEVEL	BEST FOR
Refuse plastic bags	Foldable cotton shopping bag	Fits in a school bag and can be reused.	Low	Classes 7–10
Alternative to single-use bottles	Reusable stainless-steel or suitable durable water bottle	Can replace disposable bottles.	Medium	Top prizes, Classes 7–10
Alternative to disposable food packaging	Reusable lunch/tiffin box	Can replace some disposable packets and plates.	Medium	Classes 4–8
Plants and nature	Seed packets (vegetables or suitable flowers/herbs)	Easy for children to grow; ask a local nursery which seeds suit the season and area.	Very low	Classes 4–8
Plants and nature	Small potted plant or sapling in a clay pot	A lasting reminder of the workshop.	Low–medium	Top prizes, any class
Traditional reusable alternatives	Clay pot or earthen cup	Highlights a traditional local alternative to some plastic items.	Low	Classes 5–10

7. Sponsorship Feasibility

OPTION	WHY IT MAY WORK	WHAT TO ASK FOR
Companies with sustainability programmes	Potential long-term partners; examples to research include Unilever Bangladesh, Daraz/BD Recycle Technologies, and Nippon Express Bangladesh. Verify current initiatives before referencing them in a request.	Send a short introductory request, but treat this as a possible partnership for future activities rather than relying on it for 24 October.
Local jute-product makers and shops	Jute products connect with local alternatives to polythene and may be available in small quantities.	Ask for around 20 small jute bags, pouch materials, or a discounted bulk price.
Local nursery	Seeds and saplings are practical, visible environmental gifts.	Ask for seed packets or small saplings suitable for the season.
Parents and school community	Local contributions may be easier to arrange at short notice.	Invite optional in-kind support such as reusable items, seeds, or plants.

Appendix A: Detailed Activity Instructions

Activity 1 — Human River Rescue (5 minutes)

Objective: Show the difference between a sudden mountain flood and local flooding made worse by blocked drains.

Setup: Mark a mountain end and a village end about 5–7 metres apart. Line up each team between them. Use blue strips for water and 5–10 soft paper balls for debris or waste near the marked drain area.

13. Simulate the surge (1.5 minutes): The first player passes a blue strip hand-to-hand to the last player, who places it at the village end. Count strips delivered safely.
14. Clear the drain (1.5 minutes): Start again with blue strips. At the same time, team members remove paper balls from the marked drain zone and place them in a bucket.
15. Score (30 seconds): Award 1 point for each safely delivered strip and 1 point for each paper ball removed. Use the same scoring rule for all teams.
16. Debrief (1.5 minutes): Ask whether the two rounds showed the same problem. Explain that the Nepal event was a glacier-related avalanche and flash flood, while blocked drains can worsen local urban waterlogging.

Activity 2 — No Bin? No Problem! (6 minutes)

Objective: Practise what to do with everyday waste when no bin is nearby.

Setup: Prepare four stations—Tea Stall, Bazaar, Street Cart, and Canal Bank—with a volunteer judge and 2–3 situation cards at each. Use four teams if numbers allow.

17. At “Go,” each team draws a situation card.
18. Discuss and choose a solution for about 20 seconds.
19. Act out or explain the solution in about 30 seconds.
20. The judge awards points for a practical solution, waste reduction/reuse, and a clear, polite explanation.
21. Rotate on the timekeeper’s signal, or have each team complete one station if time or space is limited.

Activity 3 — Senior FGD and Group Presentation (6 minutes)

Objective: Help students identify an environmental problem and communicate an achievable solution.

22. Assign students to groups of 5–7 before the activity begins.
23. Give each group one prompt about plastic waste, blocked drains, reusable alternatives, or a family habit.
24. Allow approximately 2.5 minutes for discussion. Each group should agree on a problem, a reason it matters, one solution, and one action for the next seven days.
25. Invite each group to present for 30–45 seconds. If there are too many groups, hear from selected groups and collect the others’ written plans.
26. Give quick, constructive feedback using the scoring criteria: understanding, practicality, teamwork, clarity, and respectful communication.

Appendix B: Donation Request Template

Send by email or message and personalise the recipient, requested item, and contact details. Add a Bangla version for local shops.

Dear [Name/Respected Sir or Madam],

On behalf of Earth’s Ants, we would like to seek your kind support for an environmental awareness workshop that we are organising in collaboration with [School Name] on 24 October 2026 for students of Classes 4–10.

Titled “The Ant Effect: From the Himalayas to Urban Streets,” the 25-minute workshop will introduce students to environmental protection, climate resilience, glacier-related flooding in Nepal, and practical ways to reduce plastic pollution in Bangladesh. Through interactive activities and student-led discussions, we hope to help young people turn environmental awareness into simple, everyday action.

We are seeking in-kind support for approximately 20 eco-friendly student prizes. Suitable contributions include jute bags, seeds or saplings, reusable bottles, and locally made clay products. Any quantity or a discount on these items would be sincerely appreciated.

Given the workshop schedule, we would be grateful if any contribution could be made available for collection by Thursday, 22 October 2026.

With your permission, we would acknowledge [Company/Shop Name] in the workshop summary report and, subject to the school's permission and applicable consent requirements, in selected event photographs. We would also welcome the opportunity to discuss a broader partnership for our planned environmental awareness activities in November.

We understand that this is a short-notice request and appreciate your consideration. Your support, however modest, could help make environmental learning more meaningful for young students.

Thank you for your time and consideration. We would be happy to share further details at your convenience.

Warm regards,

[Name]

[Role/Designation]

Earth's Ants

Phone: [Phone Number]

Email: [Email Address]

Appendix C: Roles and Responsibilities

ROLE	GROUP	NUMBER	RESPONSIBILITIES
Workshop Coordinator	Earth's Ants	1	Owns the overall plan, runs a 15-minute daily check-in, approves sponsor messages and slides, confirms the final schedule, and serves as the school's main contact.
Lead Facilitator	Earth's Ants	1	Learns the script, introduces the workshop, guides activities, leads the pledge, and hosts the prize ceremony.
Co-facilitator and Timekeeper	Earth's Ants	1	Uses a stopwatch, manages transitions, and supports crowd management with a clear clap or other agreed signal.
Content and Fact-check Lead	Earth's Ants	1	Rechecks Nepal flood information on Wednesday and Friday, drafts the video script, approves slides, and ensures there are no casualty numbers or graphic images.
Slides and Video Lead	Earth's Ants and club design member	2	Creates the slides and 90-second explainer, records narration, and saves working copies on a USB drive and phone.
Activity 1 Referee	Earth's Ants	1	Runs Human River Rescue, manages materials, and records team scores.
Prize Production Lead	Earth's Ants	2	Manages the prize plan, shopping list, preparation team, and quality checks.

Sponsor Outreach Lead	Earth’s Ants	1	Sends requests, follows up, maintains a tracking sheet, arranges collection, and sends thank-you messages.
Senior FGD Support	Earth’s Ants / school club	As needed	Forms groups, distributes prompts, supports inclusive discussion, keeps presentations on time, and records the main solutions.

Venue and Materials Checklist

- Open area with a flat floor; allow approximately 8 × 6 metres where possible.
- Screen/projector and sound system, or a facilitator who can be heard clearly.
- Blue cloth or paper strips, soft paper balls, buckets, mats or floor markers.
- Printed situation cards, discussion prompts, paper/slates, pens, scoring sheets, and timer.
- Ant Pledge cards, Ant Wall display, and 7-Day Ant Streak cards.
- Prizes, name/class list, and any approved sponsor acknowledgement.
- Backup copy of the video and slides.